

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

A favorable review!



## Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- What types of things do reviewers write about?
- Do you read reviews before you read a book or go to a movie or restaurant? Why or why not?

## Can Do Statements

- I can discuss reasons for and results of an event or action related to work and jobs.
- I can talk or report about things, actions, events, or people in a work environment.
- I can exchange complex professional information related to work and job issues.





## Let's Explore!

Denise tells Boris about the favorable **book review**\*.

\* A "book review" is a piece of writing that describes the content, aims and quality of a book.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

**Boris:** Hi Denise.

**Denise:** Oh, hi Boris. So, what do you think? The launch is going very well don't you think?

**Boris:** Yes, it seems to be. It's agreed that this is the best location for the type of launch. I really like the setup with the kids on the floor in front of Marisa.

**Denise:** Yes, it was decided that it was better to make the focus about the kids even though we need to sell the book to the parents. It was assumed that if the kids were engrossed in the parts that Marisa reads, then the parents will buy the book.

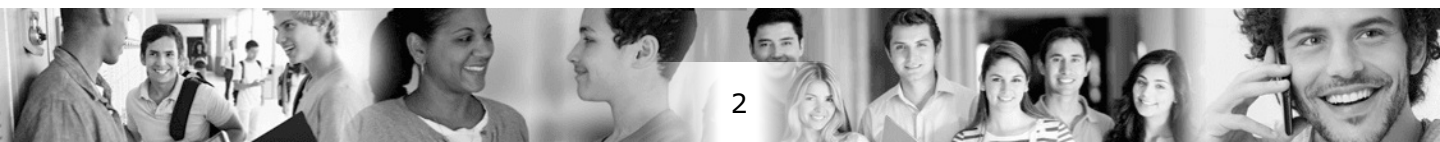
**Boris:** That makes sense. Denise, have you read any reviews of the book yet? I'm curious to know what the initial reaction is.

**Denise:** Yes, anticipating a good response, I read a review that I saw on a blog this morning. I gave an advance copy to a friend of mine because she has kids. Knowing of her concern for her kids' safety on the internet, I knew she would be interested in the book. It wasn't understood that she would review it but she did and she loved it.

**Boris:** So it was favorable? Having published a lot of children's books, I know how crucial the first reviews are.

**Denise:** Yes, she liked the concept and the story. She really enjoyed the illustrations. Having so many options for illustrators, it was hard to choose the best one for this book. My friend called the illustrations breathtaking. That's high praise! She also recommended that readers put in orders with us now. That will create even more buzz before we even release the book. It's also known that pre-release hype is the best way to increase sales, so I'm really pleased that she added this to her review.

**Boris:** Yes. Having seen first-hand how valuable that hype can be, I'm really pleased with this review, too.



**Let's Practice!**

Boris and Denise discuss the book review.

*Instructions: Circle all the reporting verbs in the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

1. It's agreed that this is the best location for this type of launch.
2. It was decided that it was better to make the focus about the kids even though we need to sell the book to the parents.
3. It was assumed that if the kids were engrossed in the parts that Marisa reads, then the parents will buy the book.
4. It wasn't understood that she would review it but she did and she loved it.
5. It's known that pre-release hype is the best way to increase sales so I'm really pleased that she added that to her review.

**Let's Practice!**

Boris explains his knowledge of book reviews.

*Instructions: Match the halves of the sentences in Column A to the corresponding ones in Column B to make correct sentences.*

**COLUMN A**

1. Yes, anticipating a good response,
2. Knowing of her concern for her kids' safety on the internet
3. Having published a lot of children's books
4. Having so many options for illustrators.
5. Having seen first hand how valuable that hype can be

**COLUMN B**

- a. \_\_\_\_ I knew she would like to read the book.
- b. \_\_\_\_ I'm really pleased with the hype from this review.
- c. \_\_\_\_ I know how crucial the first reviews are.
- d. \_\_\_\_ I read a review that I saw on a blog this morning.
- e. \_\_\_\_ It was hard to choose the best one for this book.





## Extension Activity

Write a review.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Write a review of a book you read, a movie or play you saw, a restaurant that you went to, or anything else that you want.
- Describe the experience.
- Write about what you liked and disliked and why.
- Exchange reviews with a partner.

### Self-Assessment

**Yes** **No**

I describe something that I experienced.

☐ ☐

I write about what I like and disliked about the experience.

☐ ☐

I exchange reviews with a partner and read my partner's review.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **advance copy** (noun): a copy of a book received before it is published  
e.g. I gave an advance copy to a friend of mine because she has kids.
- **initial** (adjective): first  
e.g. I'm curious to know what the initial reaction is.
- **reaction** (noun): behavior, a feeling, or an action that is a direct result of something else  
e.g. Her reaction was very positive.
- **curious** (adjective): eager to know or learn something  
e.g. I'm curious to know more about her.
- **engrossed** (adjective): having all one's attention or interest absorbed by someone or something  
e.g. It was assumed that if the kids were engrossed in the parts that Marisa reads, then the parents will buy the book.
- **favorable** (adjective): positive or pleasing  
e.g. So it was favorable?
- **praise** (noun): an expression of strong admiration or approval  
e.g. That's high praise!





## Learning Points

### -ing Forms

When you want to talk about results and time, you can use a **Perfect - ing** form. You use this type of structure when you want to emphasize that one thing happens before another. It can have the same meaning as **because**.

For example:

***Having published a lot of children's books, I know how crucial the first reviews are.***

In this case, the action that comes first is "*Having published a lot of books*". It is clear that the action "*I know how crucial the first reviews are.*" comes next.

The meaning is: *I know how crucial the first reviews are **because** I have published a lot of books.*

The form of the Perfect - ing is:

Having + past participle

Take a look at the examples from the text. Think about which event happened first.

### Examples:

- *Yes, anticipating a good response, I read a review that I saw on a blog this morning.*
- *Knowing of her concern for her kids' safety on the internet, I knew she would be interested in the book.*
- *Having so many options for illustrators, it was hard to choose the best one for this book.*
- *Having seen first-hand how valuable that hype can be, I'm really pleased with this review, too.*

### Report Verbs with Impersonal Passive Construction

When you want to report a fact or belief, you can use a variety of ways to construct your ideas. When you do not want to mention the source of the information, you can use a passive structure.

You can use the structure **It + passive verb + that + finite clause**.

A finite clause contains a verb which shows tense.

For example:

***It was reported*** that the army was crossing the frontier.

***It has been shown*** that the theory is correct.

***It is proposed*** that prices should increase next year.

We often use these verbs for reporting with impersonal passive construction:





## Learning Points

|           |         |            |
|-----------|---------|------------|
| admit     | explain | prove      |
| agree     | fear    | recommend  |
| allege    | find    | regret     |
| announce  | hope    | report     |
| assume    | intend  | reveal     |
| believe   | know    | see        |
| claim     | mention | show       |
| consider  | notice  | state      |
| declare   | object  | suggest    |
| discover  | observe | suppose    |
| establish | presume | think      |
| estimate  | promise | understand |
| expect    | propose |            |

### Examples:

- *It's agreed that this is the best location for this type of launch.*
- *It was decided that it was better to make the focus about the kids even though we need to sell the book to the parents.*
- *It was assumed that if the kids were engrossed in the parts that Marisa reads, then the parents will buy the book.*
- *It wasn't understood that she would review it but she did and she loved it.*
- *It's known that pre-release hype is the best way to increase sales so I'm really pleased that she added that to her review.*

